

PROGRESSION · LEDGER · STRUCTURE

list-criteria

Numbered criteria list — each requirement is a row with rationale.

Criteria are gates: clear them in order.

01

State the bar

Each criterion is a pass-or-fail line, not a preference.

02

Order by veto power

The criterion most likely to kill goes first.

03

Keep the list short

Three gates decide; six gates stall.

Five gates is the most one decision should clear.

01

The first gate

A criterion at the hard budget states the bar and the evidence that clears it, in one breath.

02

The second gate

Twenty-two words is the ceiling; this clause is written to sit just under it, deliberately.

03

The third gate

Middle gates read fastest — put the contested one here.

04

The fourth gate

Attention thins; shorten the clauses as the list descends.

05

The fifth gate

The stop. A sixth gate means the bar is a rubric, not a decision.

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When NOT to reach for list-criteria.

Parallel options, not gates.

If the items are alternatives the audience is choosing between, use `cards-grid` or `verdict-grid`. list-criteria is for requirements all of which must hold.

Rationale longer than two lines. Each row is a one-sentence rationale. If a criterion needs a paragraph, lift it to `list-steps` or `split-panel` where the body has room to breathe.

Missing criterion title.

The lead line on each li — rendered bold automatically — is what makes the ledger scannable. A naked sentence per row reads as paragraph soup; the title is the structure.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`list-steps` — rows are procedural steps with longer body, not gating criteria

`checklist` — rows carry done/in-flight/planned state markers

`verdict-grid` — options scored against shared criteria

`list` — declared statements — the `principles` variant

`list-tabular` — rows carry structured metadata alongside the name and description